# Sébastien Montpetit

sebastienmontpetit.com | sebastien.montpetit1@gmail.com | +44 7460 300337
Canadian, French | French (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

## Current position

**Research Fellow (postdoc)** *Department of Economics, University of Warwick* Sept 2024-

## Research fields

Public economics, gender economics, applied microeconomics

## Education

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| **Ph.D. Economics** | *Toulouse School of Economics* | 2018-2024 |
| • Research visit | *Université du Québec à Montréal* | Summer 2023 |
| • Research visit | *Vancouver School of Economics* | Fall 2022 |
| **M.A. Economics** | *McGill University* | 2017-2018 |
| **B.Sc. Economics** | *Université du Québec à Montréal* | 2014-2017 |
| • International exchange | *Université de Liège* | Winter 2016 |

## Publication

1. **Reproducibility and Robustness of Economics and Political Science Research** (with Abel Brodeur, Derek Mikola, Nikolai Cook, Lenka Fiala, and many others), *Nature* (652), 151–156, 2026

## Working Papers

2. **A Welfare Analysis of Universal Childcare: Lessons From a Canadian Reform** (with Luisa Carrer and Pierre-Loup Beauregard). Job Market Paper, *submitted*
    - *Best Paper Award 2024 (runner-up) of the Canadian Labour Economics Forum*

Abstract: We assess the welfare impact of the introduction of universal daycare services in Québec in 1997. Unlike the standard sufficient-statistics metric, which assumes marginal changes in fiscal policy, our approach accounts for the non-marginal nature of the program and quantifies non-pecuniary benefits. Through a structural model of childcare demand, we estimate substantial welfare gains from the policy, yielding a Marginal Value of Public Funds (MVPF) above 2.8. Using the sufficient-statistics approach underestimates welfare gains by half. Counterfactual simulations and a difference-in-differences analysis suggest that increasing availability, rather than solely improving affordability, is crucial for the effective design of universal programs.

3. **Veiling and the Economic Integration of Muslim Women in France** (with Antoine Jacquet)
    - *Revised and Resubmitted at* ***Canadian Journal of Economics***

Abstract: This paper provides the first empirical evidence on the economic costs of wearing the Islamic veil and on motives for veiling in a secular Western country. Using French observational data rather than small-scale interviews, we demonstrate a significant negative correlation between veiling and economic participation, even conditional on the respondent's religious environment. Using a structural interpretation of a theoretical model of veiling and labor-market participation, we then disentangle

the various motivations behind the joint decision to veil and to be economically active. Our findings indicate that veiled women are less economically active not due to religious preferences, but rather because of lower economic returns to integration. Additionally, our results emphasize the significance of personal religious motives in the decision to veil, rather than signaling piety to others.

# Work in Progress

4. **Behind the Veil of Origin: Revisiting the Impacts of the French Headscarf Ban in Schools**

Abstract: This paper examines the impact of prohibiting the Islamic veil in schools on economic outcomes and long-run integration of Muslim women. Using a difference-in-differences design, I show that the 1994 directive instructing school principals to ban the veil led to a substantial decline in educational attainment among affected cohorts, with persistent consequences for employment and marriage market outcomes. An analysis of mechanisms suggests that these effects stem primarily from heightened perceptions of discrimination and mistrust toward the French school system, rather than shifts in parental educational investments. I also show that misclassification of religion in prior work introduces substantial bias. Despite the adverse economic consequences, the affected cohorts exhibit stronger identification with France but also higher levels of religiosity, suggesting a mixed long-run impact on cultural assimilation.

5. **Intergenerational Transmission of Victimization** (with Sonia Bhalotra, N. Meltem Daysal, Mathias Fjællegaard Jensen, and Thomas H. Jørgensen)

Abstract: Using four decades of individual linked administrative data from Denmark, we provide the first estimates of intergenerational transmission of victimization, focusing on violent crime. We find that, if a parent was victimized then the chances that a son is victimized double and the chances that a daughter is victimized treble. These associations hold for fathers and mothers and are stronger when the mother is victim. Introducing controls for cohort and neighbourhood fixed effects, parent's socioeconomic status, parental cohabitation and whether the parent was a crime perpetrator explains about 60% of intergenerational transmission. The intergenerational link is significantly attenuated among families with above-median income, particularly for daughters. Similarly, exposed children display significantly lower absolute income mobility—around 8.5 and 5.8 rank points for sons and daughters—, and these gaps persist for sons even among higher-income families.

6. **Are Climate Policies Marginal? A Welfare Evaluation of Environmental Reforms** (with Jean-François Fournel)

Abstract: Which climate investments should policymakers prioritize? We develop a framework that combines the Marginal Value of Public Funds (MVPF) with structural models of demand for green technologies to evaluate the welfare effects of environmental reforms. Our approach traces the MVPF across the entire policy spectrum using counterfactual simulations, thereby relaxing the constant-elasticity and "small-change" assumptions of sufficient-statistics methods. We apply our methodology to the Canadian electric vehicle market, following Fournel (2025). The analysis reveals strong nonlinearities in the cost-effectiveness of electric vehicle incentives: initial subsidies yield substantial welfare gains, but diminishing returns make large subsidies inefficient. At average subsidy levels, we estimate an MVPF of 1.07, indicating modest social returns. Counterfactual simulations suggest that investing in charging-station deployment generates the highest welfare gains, while taxing fuel-inefficient vehicles is not an efficient funding source.

## Awards and Grants

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| Replication Grant | *Institute for Replication*, €1,623 | 2025 |
| Best Paper Award (runner-up) | *Canadian Labour Economics Forum* | 2024 |
| CEA Student Travel Grant | *Productivity Partnership* | 2024 |
| TSE Job Market Fellowship | *Toulouse School of Economics* | 2023-2024 |
| Frontenac Scholarship | *Fonds de recherche Nature et Technologies Québec* | 2018 |
| Graduate Excellence Fellowship | *McGill University* | 2017-2018 |
| Coop-UQAM Scholarship | *Université du Québec à Montréal* | 2016 |
| Martial-Nkamani Scholarship | *Université du Québec à Montréal* | 2015 |

## Research and teaching assistance

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|---|---|---|
| Microéconomie 2 (undergraduate) | with L. Bottega (TSE) | 2021-2023 |
| Causal Inference with Observational Data (graduate) | with M. Bobba (TSE) | 2021 |
| Introduction to Economics for Biologists (graduate) | with F. Salanié (TSE) | 2020-2021 |
| Economic Development II (undergraduate) | with F. Grimard (McGill) | 2018 |
| Research assistant | for F. Grimard (ISID, McGill) | 2018 |
| Money, Banking & Gov. Policy (undergraduate) | with N.M. Wasi Uddin (McGill) | 2017 |

## Seminars and conferences

2026 : AXA Gender Lab at Università Bocconi, Policy Impacts conference (MIT, scheduled), University of Konstanz (scheduled), QMUL Workshop in Economics and Finance (London, scheduled), GEP Labour and Globalization Workshop (Nottingham, scheduled), 5th Transatlantic Workshop on the Economics of Crime (IFS, scheduled)

2025 : TEPP (Rennes), Institute for Fiscal Studies, Journées LAGV (Aix-Marseille)

2024 : ENS de Lyon, McGill, Sherbrooke, SBCA (Washington), CEA (Toronto)

2023 : NSE PhD & Postdoc Workshop (Naples), CEA (Winnipeg), SCSE (Québec City), CIREQ PhD Conference (Montréal), Université du Québec à Montréal, Stockholm University

2022 : ASREC Graduate Workshop (online)

## Refereeing services

*Quarterly Journal of Economics, Journal of Health Economics, Journal of Development Economics, Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization, Canadian Journal of Economics, Agence Nationale de la Recherche*

## Outreach

**Media** NY Times, Le Devoir, La Presse, Le Monde (x2), Les Échos, Radio-Canada Ottawa, CJAD 800 Montreal, 107.7fm Estrie, Zone Économie (Radio-Canada), 98.5fm Montréal

**Academic** Childcarepolicy.net, Policy Impacts Library, AYEW Job Market Vlog

## References

**Sonia Bhalotra**
University of Warwick
Sonia.Bhalotra@warwick.ac.uk
+44 7738 688098

**Philippe Bontems**
TSE, INRAE
philippe.bontems@inrae.fr
+33 (0)5 61 12 86 09

**Jean-William P. Laliberté**
University of Calgary
jeanwilliam.lalibert@ucalgary.ca
+1 416-830-6244